



DREAMS ON WHEELS

A positive business environment and an aspirational lifestyle have been driving luxury car sales in India

○ FY21 SALES ○ FY22 SALES

ROLLS-ROYCE
○ 21 ○ 17

BENTLEY
MOTORS
○ 13 ○ 26

AUTOMOBILI
LAMBORGHINI
○ 28 ○ 63

PORSCHE AG
○ 251 ○ 413

AUDI AG
○ 409 ○ 1,088

JAGUAR LAND
ROVER INDIA
○ 1,706 ○ 1,923

BMW INDIA
○ 5,856 ○ 8,320

MERCEDES-BENZ
GROUP
○ 7,260 ○ 10,874

Figures are retail sales in units; **Source:** FADA

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Schwenk says that with a younger audience coming to the fore, customisation is the key driving factor for luxury buyers. “Customisation reflects their personality in terms of colour, accents, combination. For example, the new Mercedes-Maybach 680S takes individualisation to the next level with designer wooden backrest trim to different types of upholstery, alloy wheels, and certain features like rear-axle steering, urban guard protection, steering wheel, Burmester sound systems, among others. In terms of colour combinations, there are 10 options for a special two-tone paint to make each Maybach distinct,” he adds. “Another brilliant example of tech-driven personalisation and sensory experience we recently debuted in India with the EQS is the MBUX Hyperscreen, which has 800 personalisation parameters,” he says.

And technology, of course, plays a huge role for

luxury carmakers in differentiating themselves. Mercedes-Benz today has the largest collection of connected luxury vehicles—67,000 of them—in the country.

Italian carmaker Lamborghini, too, has seen a growing demand for customisation combined with cutting-edge technology. “While the Indian market is very small and niche, the buyer segment is very evolved. People spend up to 25 per cent of the car value in personalisation. They want to create a car that reflects their lifestyle. From unique colours, stitching and patterns on the leather, young buyers are going in for all sorts of customisations,” says Sharad Agarwal, Head of Lamborghini India. “Some people want their initials embossed in the interiors. They want to change the colour of the leather. That’s why each and every Lamborghini is unique in its own way.”

With the age of the average luxury buyer coming down, there has also been a shift in where that buyer